

PDCA Bibliography and Further Reading

Selected Publications Across the Development of Plan-Do-Check-Act

Purpose

This bibliography provides a working reference collection for readers wishing to explore the origins, evolution, application, and critique of PDCA and related improvement cycles.

Coverage is intentionally broad and includes foundational works, historical interpretations, practical implementation guides, quality management texts, and adjacent models.

Foundations and Scientific Origins

Bacon, F. (1620).
Novum Organum.

One of the philosophical foundations of iterative inquiry and experimentation.

Shewhart, W.A. (1931).
Economic Control of Quality of Manufactured Product.
New York: Van Nostrand.

Widely regarded as foundational to statistical quality control and precursor thinking behind later iterative improvement cycles.

Shewhart, W.A. (1939).
Statistical Method from the Viewpoint of Quality Control.
Washington, DC.

Introduced Shewhart's improvement logic and experimental approach.

Early Quality and Improvement Development

Deming, W.E. (1950).
Lectures delivered to JUSE (Japanese Union of Scientists and Engineers).

Often referenced as a major influence in development of PDCA in Japanese quality practice.

Deming, W.E. (1982).
Quality, Productivity and Competitive Position.
MIT.

Deming, W.E. (1986).
Out of the Crisis.
MIT Center for Advanced Engineering Study.

Classic management and quality work.

Deming, W.E. (1993).
The New Economics for Industry, Government, Education.
MIT Press.

Contains Deming's later preference for PDSA over PDCA.

Japanese Quality and Continuous Improvement

Imai, M. (1986).
Kaizen: The Key to Japan's Competitive Success.
McGraw-Hill.

Ishikawa, K. (1985).
What Is Total Quality Control? The Japanese Way.
Prentice Hall.

Taguchi, G. (1986).
Introduction to Quality Engineering.

Mizuno, S. (1988).
Company-Wide Total Quality Control.

Lean, Toyota and Operational Improvement

Liker, J. (2004).
The Toyota Way.
McGraw-Hill.

Rother, M. (2010).
Toyota Kata.
McGraw-Hill.

Strong practical operational interpretation of iterative improvement.

Ohno, T. (1988).
Toyota Production System.
Productivity Press.

Improvement Science and Practical Application

Langley, G.J.; Moen, R.; Nolan, K.; Nolan, T.; Norman, C.; Provost, L. (2009).
The Improvement Guide: A Practical Approach to Enhancing Organizational Performance.
Jossey-Bass.

One of the most practical modern texts applying PDSA.

Moen, R.; Norman, C. (2009).
Evolution of the PDCA Cycle.
Asian Network for Quality Conference.

Frequently cited historical synthesis.

Taylor, M.J. et al. (2013).
Systematic Review of the Application of the Plan–Do–Study–Act Method.
BMJ Quality & Safety.

Quality and Management System Literature

Juran, J.M.; Godfrey, A.B. (1999).
Juran's Quality Handbook.

Tague, N.R. (2005).
The Quality Toolbox.
ASQ Quality Press.

Evans, J.R.; Lindsay, W.M. (Various editions).
Managing for Quality and Performance Excellence.

Goetsch, D.; Davis, S. (Various editions).
Quality Management for Organizational Excellence.

Standards and Governance

ISO 9001 (multiple editions).
Quality Management Systems — Requirements.

PDCA is embedded as a recurring implementation principle.

ISO 14001 (multiple editions).
Environmental Management Systems.

ISO 45001 (multiple editions).
Occupational Health and Safety Management Systems.

ISO/IEC 27001 (multiple editions).
Information Security Management Systems.

Adjacent and Comparative Cycles

Boyd, J.
OODA Loop
Observe–Orient–Decide–Act.

Kolb, D. (1984).
Experiential Learning.

Goldratt, E. (1984).
The Goal.

George, M. (2002).
Lean Six Sigma.

Harry, M.; Schroeder, R. (2000).
Six Sigma.

Digital, Process and Maturity Evolution

Cusick, J.J. (2019).
A Survey of Maturity Models from Nolan to DevOps and Their Applications in Process Improvement.
arXiv.

Humble, J.; Farley, D. (2010).
Continuous Delivery.

Kim, G.; Humble, J.; Debois, P.; Willis, J. (2016).
The DevOps Handbook.

Public Guides and Practitioner References

American Society for Quality (ASQ).
PDCA Cycle Resource.

Lean Enterprise Institute.
PDCA Resource Guide.

W. Edwards Deming Institute.
PDSA Cycle Resource.

PECB.
PDCA Continuous Improvement Guide.

Notes for CIPDA Readers

PDCA has evolved over nearly a century.

Its literature spans:

- scientific experimentation
- industrial quality
- organisational learning
- operational excellence
- governance
- digital transformation

Readers are encouraged to understand the lineage before extending it.